

Cover Letter

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July 24, 2025

Hiring Manager
Affirm

Remote, US

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am thrilled to apply for the Senior Staff Software Engineer, Backend (Search & Discovery) position at Affirm. With a Master of Computer Science from Texas Tech University (GPA: 4.0/4.0) and over 20 years of experience building scalable distributed systems, I am eager to drive technical innovation in Affirm's Discovery domain, enhancing user engagement through personalized financial solutions.

At Biophy (2025-Present), I architected a **Python** and **Terraform**-based IaC framework on **AWS** (EKS, S3, Lambda), developing real-time data pipelines with **FastAPI** and **MySQL**, improving user-facing platform performance by 40%. At Yotascale (2020-2021), I designed **Python**-based microservices with **Kubernetes** and **OpenAPI/Swagger**, creating APIs for consumer analytics, aligning with Affirm's focus on search and marketplace tooling. At McKinsey (2021-2025), I built **Spark**-powered data pipelines, optimizing merchant data processing for scalability.

My collaborative leadership shines through mentoring engineers and aligning with product teams, as seen at Barclays (2017-2020), where I developed **Kafka**-driven APIs for fintech systems. I am passionate about Affirm's mission and excited to shape scalable architectures, drive user-focused innovation, and foster technical excellence. Please contact me at 856-408-4027 or rongyj@hotmail.com to discuss further.

Sincerely,
Yongjun Rong